

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 552

By Boyd

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Dorothy Steffen on the celebration of her 100th birthday.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we pay tribute to those citizens who are celebrating special occasions in their estimable lives; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Steffen will celebrate her 100th birthday on October 6, 2025, a milestone that will be commemorated as yet another precious souvenir of life's rich pageant; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Steffen was born on October 6, 1925, in Cuba, Missouri; the youngest of six children, she spent her childhood on a farm and feed mill owned by her father; and

WHEREAS, she attended school in Cuba before moving to Rolla, Missouri, where she graduated from high school and took secretarial classes; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Steffen met her future husband, Lee Steffen, in Rolla, where he was attending seminary to become a Missouri Synod Lutheran minister; the young couple was joined in holy matrimony in 1945 after Mr. Steffen finished his vicarage; and

WHEREAS, Reverend Steffen's first church was in Clearwater, Nebraska; moving there shortly after their marriage, the Steffens lived in Nebraska for six years and welcomed three sons; and

WHEREAS, Reverend and Mrs. Steffen next moved to Spencer, Iowa, where their fourth son was born; and

WHEREAS, Dorothy Steffen loved the life of a homemaker and pastor's wife, despite the frequent relocations; in 1964, the Steffens moved to a new church in Lakeland, Florida, where they served faithfully until 1988; and

WHEREAS, after their twenty-four-year tenure in Florida, the Reverend and Mrs. Steffen moved to Franklin, North Carolina, where they enjoyed their home in the mountains and a semi-retired life; and

WHEREAS, following her beloved husband's passing in 2008, Dorothy Steffen continued to live independently for many years; and

WHEREAS, after experiencing a fall in 2023, Mrs. Steffen moved to Tennessee to live with her third son, Paul, and eventually transitioned to American House in Lebanon; and

WHEREAS, Mrs. Steffen has always enjoyed Tennessee, often visiting her son and his family here over the years, and she is happy to now call the Volunteer State home as she celebrates a century of life filled with love, faith, and family; and

WHEREAS, this proud matriarch has nine grandchildren and nineteen great-grandchildren scattered about the United States and Australia; and

WHEREAS, we wish to grasp this golden opportunity to specially recognize one of Tennessee's most outstanding citizens on this very special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Dorothy Steffen on the celebration of her 100th birthday and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.